

← Case report for event ID: 1023

ID	Alert rule	Description	Incident type	Severity level	Date and time detected
1023	Suspicious Parent Child Relationship	A suspicious process with an uncommon parent-child relationship was detected in your environment.	Process	Low	Dec 27th 2025 at 23:55

Alert details ▾

Incident report

Edit report

Incident classification

☒ True positive☐ False positive

Case report

Please write a detailed report on the steps taken to analyse and contain this incident, including all relevant information and the rationale for its closure.

Submitted report:

- Time of Incident: 12/27/2025 15:53:06.164

- User Involved: According to Company Information - Directory:
Name: Michael Ascot
Email: michael.ascot@tryhatme.com
Role: CEO
Logged-In Host: win-3450

- Device: win-3450 (Windows host)

- Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:53:06.164, a process creation event was logged where "Robocopy.exe" (PID 8356) was launched by "powershell.exe" (PID 3728) from "Z:\". The command executed was "C:\Windows\system32\Robocopy.exe" C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\exfiltration /E", indicating that files from the current directory were copied recursively to a local path. This parent-child relationship is flagged due to unusual activity and potential exfiltration behavior.

Does this alert require escalation?

☒ Yes☐ No

Save and Close report

Alert 1023: Process

- Identified as True Positive
- Requires escalation to L2
- Full Report Documented on the last page

splunk>enterpriseApps

MessagesSettingsActivityHelpFind

SearchAnalyticsDatasetsReportsAlertsDashboards

Search & Reporting

New Search

Save As>Create Table ViewClose

1 host.name="win-3450" process.name="Robocopy.exe" process.parent.name="powershell.exe"

6 day window

1 of 3 events matchedNo Event Sampling

Events (1)PatternsStatisticsVisualization

Format TimelineZoom OutZoom to SelectionDeselect

1 hour per column

ListFormat50 Per Page

< Hide Fields

▮ All Fields

SELECTED FIELDS

a host 1

a source 1

a sourcetype 1

INTERESTING FIELDS

a datasource 1

a event.action 1

a event.code 1

a host.name 1

a index 1

linecount 1

a process.command_line 1

a process.name 1

a process.parent.name 1

a process.parent.pid 1

a process.pid 1

a process.working_directory 1

a punct 1

a splunk_server 1

a timestamp 1

+ Extract New Fields

i

Time

Event

>

12/27/25

3:54:19.248 PM

{ [-]

datasource: sysmon

event.action: Process Create (rule: ProcessCreate)

event.code: 1

host.name: win-3450

process.command_line: "C:\Windows\system32\Robocopy.exe" . C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\exfiltration /E

process.name: Robocopy.exe

process.parent.name: powershell.exe

process.parent.pid: 3,728

process.pid: 8356

process.working_directory: Z:\

timestamp: 12/27/2025 15:54:19.248

}

Show as raw text

host = 10.10.178.106.8989 | source = eventcollector | sourcetype = _json

SIEM Investigation

- For reference: The incident occurred only once in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20)

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Name: Michael Ascot

Email: michael.ascot@tryhatme.com

Role: CEO

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- Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:53:06.164, a process creation event was logged where `Robocopy.exe` (PID 8356) was launched by `powershell.exe` (PID 3728) from `Z:\`. The command executed was `"C:\Windows\system32\Robocopy.exe" . C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\exfiltration /E`, indicating that files from the current directory were copied recursively to a local path. This parent-child relationship is flagged due to unusual activity and potential exfiltration behavior.

- Malware Identified: None identified. Suspicious file copy activity detected.

- Additional Investigation: The incident occurred only once in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20) according to SIEM Logs

- Additional info:

- Parent Process: `powershell.exe` is capable of running scripts and commands, often used in administrative tasks or automation.

- Child Process: `Robocopy.exe` is a Windows utility for copying files and directories.

- Why This Is Uncommon: Using `Robocopy.exe` through PowerShell from a network-mapped drive to copy data to a local folder is atypical user behavior. This pattern is often associated with data staging or exfiltration and should be investigated.

- Recommendations: Escalate to Level 2 (L2) for further investigation and handling.

- This is a True Positive

- This needs escalation to L2 for further investigation